Next Stop, Please!

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/65502544.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra/Glimmer (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra)

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Alternate Universe - Modern with Magic, Trucker!Glimmer AU (She-Ra), Catra has a magic allergy AS PER CANON FIGHT ME (She-Ra), Magical Realism, Meet-Cute, Vomiting, World Travel, Abandoned Work - Unfinished and Discontinued, Glimmer is a hot mess (She-Ra), Catra is a hotter mess (She-Ra), Micah means well (She-Ra), Catra doesn't know how to flirt (She-Ra)

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English

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Part 8 of Making Light Hope Proud (WiPs I Won't Continue)

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by Nny11

Summary

Glimmer is a licensed and certified transporter for living goods and large loads, AKA a magical trucker without the truck. And unfortunately for her, Catra is about to make that a problem.

Chapter 1

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“And it’s safe?”

Glimmer, miraculously, fought off an eye twitch as she heard the magicat ask the same question for at least the hundredth time! Okay, more like tenth, but it felt like a lot more!

“Perfectly safe, I use both teleportation and her services, specifically, all the time.” This time, her father managed to not throw a crazy wink towards her which probably would help sell her capabilities a lot more if he hadn’t already done so twice.

Glimmer took a slow deep breath in and out, trying to let go of her frustration at the same time. It really wasn’t this poor, terrified woman’s fault at all. Glimmer was just used to fighting against people who didn’t believe in her, who didn’t trust her, who thought of her as weak and incompetent. Despite being one of the rare mage’s born with an innate ability to teleport, Glimmer had still been forced to learn how to do it using glyphs and rune work just like everyone else. It had been an exercise in frustration as she unlearned how to teleport by feel and instead focused on teleporting through strict, cold line work made even more unpleasant by the fact that if she was ever too low on magic to teleport her way then she was beyond out for a traditional circle. Her instructors had been brutal, not wanting to be seen as going easier on her than their other students. Her examiners had been worse because they’d also been petty about it, so Glimmer was the first person in a hundred years who had to retake the

transportation training and exam. It had been investigated, and the jerk who did it fired, but at that point it was a pride thing and Glimmer stuck it out to prove she knew it.

Three years of hard work later and she was finally a licensed and certified transporter for living goods and large loads.

The pay was pretty damn good, she got to set her own hours within reason, and she got to see the world as she did. She was skilled, she was trusted, and she did it all under the well respected badge of Mystacor. Bow had sat down with her to help her muddle through finances just last month and calculated that she was actually on track for an early retirement too. So life was good.

It was.

She was just… ugh, her head wasn't in the game today. She'd already done three transports but there'd been nothing else to move at each stop, forcing her to locate the nearest guild center and practically beg for work. And the annoyance and boredom of that particularly dumb part of her job had made her a bit too eager when her dad had pinged her with a transportation request for a total normie. She didn't graduate with the nickname "Angel's Touch" for nothing, she was one of the best transporters for someone who'd never teleported before. Normally she liked doing it too, they were often scared but very excited by such an unknown or exotic process; many of them going on the first vacation of their lives or getting to return home and see family after being away for years. Teleportation was cheaper than airfare, it just wasn't a guarantee you'd have a transporter and if you did that they wouldn't upcharge for luggage or numbers.

Glimmer loved being the person who helped someone out, got to see their excitement turn to wonder and she did it without upselling or hidden fees, thank you very much!

This, however, was not that.

“Sir-”

“Oh, don’t you sir me!”

The woman glared harder before all but sneering, “Mister Man Sir Bossman, if I leave now I can get there in three hours on the 25. In and out, I’ll be back before my shift is even over!”

Glimmer snorted and shrugged as they both looked at her in exasperation. Not her circus, not her monkeys.

“Or you can be teleported by one of the best in the business, only use up an hour max, and then be back in time for lunch- all through a perfectly safe and vetted transporter! I’m paying for it, and I want to take you out for your birthday, damn it!” Her dad glanced over to wink at her, that made three, jesus christ. “We’re going to the Grotto!”

“Oh they’re fantastic,” Glimmer agreed knowing that was the plan because her dad had all but cried when he realized his executive assistant hadn’t bothered to tell him her birthday was this week,

and he hadn't known which restaurants were safe to take a magicat. And if either Sea Hawk or Mermista had managed to not be the most ridiculously dramatic messy queers they are, with at least two exes being magicats (one for Mermista and both for Hawk), Glimmer wouldn't have had a clue either. But, you know, bonuses. "I love the scallops there, they don't skimp like some places."

"Uh-huh, great, well, I'm allergic to scallops so thanks for that." The woman was definitely smiling as she turned away, pleased at whatever facial journey Glimmer had unwillingly embarked on. "Seriously, please let me drive."

"No can do, not on your birthday, buddy."

"It would be a birthday gift to let me drive, I **like** driving!"

"Oooor you can stop trying to avoid the obligatory birthday lunch and we can spend three hours doing all you can eat sushi."

"That's-!" The woman cleared her throat harshly, ears perked forward and tail tip flickering. "That's cheating!"

Her father smirked. "Go gettem tiger."

"Aaaaand that's racist."

“Okay,” Glimmer huffed, stepping between them to glare the woman down, “first you know it wasn’t, second no it isn’t, third this is annoying, fourth you are literally dragging it out for all of us. I could get other jobs and not watch you turn down a literal free lunch where I know for a fact there will be alcohol involved on company time. So, are you being contrary to be a jerk, or is there actually a reason for this show? If you’re scared, tell me what you’re scared of, I can explain it to you and if you still hate it and won’t do it period then we can all move on.”

“I’m not scared!” It would’ve been more convincing if she hadn’t fluffed up a bit while hissing.

“Great, then let’s go!” Glimmer smiled widely and held her hand out expectantly.

She’d learned a long time ago to at least pretend to take people at their word, it forced customers who really shouldn’t be teleported to fess up a lot quicker. It was still up in the air if this was the same sort of thing or not. It often seemed like something small or silly when people were scared, but it rarely actually was. Of course it could be one of those asshole cases where as soon as they get confronted they crumble like a house of cards.

The woman glared at her, glared at her hand, glared at her dad, and with a huff that bordered on a hiss slapped her hand into Glimmer’s. “Fine, do it then.”

Typical asshole then. Glimmer smiled through her gritted teeth. “Great!”

And with that she teleported them.

She knew her aunt’s office like the back of her hand, she knew exactly where the teleportation arrival zone was and had already gotten a confirmation it would remain empty until after her transport. So knowing all was well, Glimmer let herself enjoy the moment in between places.

Most people thought of experiencing teleportation like physically moving through space, which made sense, it was their only frame of reference. But teleportation was actually more like watching the planet move through physical space. The magic glowed softly on her skin, spreading to cover her companion, and then outside their little space everything moved. Her father’s smiling face blurred into a rush of blue and purple and grey as she took them hundreds of miles away. The ground felt solid under their feet, but if you knew what to look for you could see the after image of Mystacor’s cloud sea under them for a microsecond. The air itself became hazy as they left the more humid grounds of Bright Moon and cleared as they reached above the clouds to the cold crisp air of the floating island. Everything, all of it, start to finish, took perhaps half a second at the very most before the magic dropped away again.

Glimmer was pretty sure it was the best feeling in the whole wide world! Invigorating and grounding all at once!

The woman, however, literally collapsed onto her knees and gagged.

"Oh shit!" Glimmer popped over to grab the waste bin and teleported back to shove it under the woman's face as she began to retch. "Oh fuck, are you okay!?"

"N-no!" Despite the rough tone the anger was a little cut out at the knees by her misery as she forced it out between two bouts of heavy vomit.

Okay, so NOT a typical asshole, fuck!

"Oh dear!" Her aunt gasped, clucking like a mother hen as she rushed to shove a bottle of water into the woman's hands, a futile attempt considering the death grip she had on the waste bin. "Oh, Catra, oh you poor thing!"

"Fffffucking thought it was safe!" Catra groused, then gagged, then miserably moaned before a third wet splash hit the bottom of the bin.

Glimmer couldn't help the way her stomach dropped or spine straightened. "It is! That's not a normal reaction at all- is that why you were scared!? Did you know something like this would happen and didn't tell us??"

Catra finally let go of the bin to flip her off with one hand, only to end up holding a water bottle in the most batshit manner possible as her aunt took the opening. She rinsed her mouth out and leaned back to sip at it delicately before answering, "I didn't know *that* would happen."

"But you knew something would happen?" Whatever guilt she'd been feeling at the outset was burned clean off. "This falls under the whole, do you know of any adverse effects of alteration magic usage on your person part of the paperwork you signed!"

"Does it?" Catra sneered as best she could while still looking two seconds from needing the bin again.

"Did you not tell her about your allergy?" Aunt Casta butted in. "Wait, did my brother not tell you about her allergy!?" Glimmer barely started to shake her head before being cut off again. "Oooooh! I'm going to kill that man! Apologies to you, I know you love your father, but he's dead now- on her birthday, Micah, honestly!"

Glimmer managed to sputter, her vindication and guilt and frustration all swinging wildly around into some unholy kind of shell shock, "Allergy? Wait, people can actually have magic allergies?"

Glimmer had heard about it before, but considering how magic was literally everywhere and everyone had some level of it in them, she'd written it off as an old crone's tale.

Catra, a magicat, probably swimming in free magic whorls, winced. “I’m not allergic!”

Aunt Castaspella put her fists on her hips and bent at the waist to put them at the same height. Hesitating before braving the stench to lean over the makeshift chuckitbucket, “Refusing to be tested to be formally diagnosed with it does not preclude you from having a very classic case of it.”

Catra squawked with indignation, turned deathly pale, had her ears gone totally limp, and immediately doubled over to hurl again.

“Well, thank you Glimmer for bringing her, I assumed this had been discussed and there was a method that would be less impactful. Tell the zombie-to-be-that-was-my-brother she’ll drive home in a cozy new sweater and I expect her to have tomorrow off.”

Catra was a bit too busy being ill to fight back and Glimmer was feeling a whole cocktail of warring emotions that were sending her stomach over a cliff the longer she was forced to listen and smell the outcome. So she happily teleported back and stared at her father until his smile was completely gone and replaced by the kind of confusion she normally associated with puppies.

“Where’s Catra?” He asked cautiously.

“She has a magic allergy, and was transported with teleportation, so, Aunt Casta says you are Very Dead to her and Catra will drive back in a cozy sweater and better have tomorrow off.”

Her father blinked rapidly as he clearly took in this brand new information before slapping a hand over his face. Sheer pain in his voice as he double checked the apparently unknown, or at the least, forgotten information.“She has an allergy?”

“Yup.” Was it bad that was glad her dad felt bad? Probably, but it really did help her not feel like the unlikely villain of that poor woman’s day. Also she was petty as hell and if she review bombed Glimmer because of her dad- oh, he’d wish his sister got there first.

He nodded in thought, a little pale and sweaty. “Do I need to hide on Beast Island to survive the fallout of this?”

“Probably for the best, but mom will hunt you down.”

“It’s fine, post birthday sushi is all the rage before fleeing for one’s life.”

Glimmer logged herself into the system to flag herself as open for new transports by closing the ticket out. “Tip me well and I’ll lie and agree with that.”

Fifty bucks richer just like that!

Chapter End Notes

If there's actual interest for this fic it might actually bring it back to life, but as of right now it languishes and so do I

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

If at first you don't succeed, try, try again!

“Oh, hello again. Uhm, feeling better?” Glimmer winced as she asked. Ultimately she’d felt stupidly guilty about the whole Catra thing and how she’d handled it. Not her finest moment, but she’d not dealt with it thanks to knowing she’d never see the woman again, a perfectly mature response to a situation she couldn’t change. Thank you very much, *Bow* .

Except here Catra was, reluctant but determined as she stomped over. “Yeah, it passed within five minutes and I felt normal afterwards. How do I hire you?”

Okay then.

“Uhm, you can use the app-”

“Absolutely not.”

Okay then!

“Or I can mark myself as on a job, but I can’t give you a price until I get into the system. But I promise to put a discount on it since- yeah. What do you need transported?” Glimmer had

already pulled out her tablet and was locking it in, so all she saw was Catra's shifting feet.

"Uhm, me?"

She barked an incredulous laugh, but the magicat only pinned her ears back in response. Oh shit.

"After last time? No."

"No- listen!" Catra deflated, running a hand through her hair, before soldiering on, "I did some research, I took the stupid container, it won't be so bad."

Glimmer stared at her for a moment before sighing heavily before starting to explain exactly why it wasn't going to work. Magic containers could work wonders but there weren't any studies regarding if it worked with teleportation seeing as teleportation usually dispelled the container wholesale. She carefully tried to explain the intricacies to her would-be customer, she really did, but the longer she spoke the more Catra clearly didn't care. In fact her speech, pulled directly from the training manual, was interrupted as Catra jumped into the first second of silence she could find.

"Good to know, let's do some science then, because I need to get a teleport. So I can either go with you, who knows something about it, or hire someone else. Your choice."

Ugh! “What in the world could possibly-”

“One of my best friends is getting engaged tonight and the stupid fucking invitation to surprise her afterwards got delayed reaching me and they live in Dryl. I am not missing this. Five minutes of misery or not, fuck it, I’m going.” Catra held her arm out stiffly where a scrap of paper had ‘New Castle Station - Dryl’ scratched out on it. “So, please, just take me before my nerves give out on me!”

Glimmer paused, and looked at the woman again. She’d learned a lot about Catra from her dad after their debacle of a first meeting, which included how she was a softie under the hard shell but still a jerk and would rather die than admit to any weakness. And here she was lightly trembling but ready to go. Glimmer softly sighed and reached out for the paper. They were both going to regret this, but she was a sucker for a good narrative.

“Okay all I’m saying is I can’t promise it’ll work.”

Catra laughed nervously as she fumbled a black plastic bag out of her pocket, revealing a kitchen trash bag. “I’m prepared for that.”

Damn, that kind of weirdly confident air about doing something stupid was just a good look on her.

“Okay, let’s get you there then!”

Glimmer held out her hand, and Catra took it with a grateful smile. “Preesh.”

She laughed as the magic started, the world blurred, and the strange world of Dryl came into being around them. There was a slight static pop from the noise difference, going from quiet to loud as speakers blared and technology beeped. Outside the frosted glass windows was a sea of people rushing through the subway to get to their destinations. Inside there was a small line of folks talking to the counter, literally the counter. Dryl had some of the most advanced bots and AI on the planet, so the counter came equipped with a little cartoon face on it that changed as it interacted with the guests.

Glimmer had taken it all in before they’d even fully materialized on the landing pad with a smile. She really needed to visit more often, Dryl was kind of like an adult playground and during the day it had the distinct bonus of not being washed out in drunken dumbasses. Someday she promised herself to hike up the mountain that loomed above the capital city.

Honestly it was a little funny and a little sad that she hadn’t made the time to do it. When you could magically go anywhere in the world it weirdly made the world both larger and smaller in scope. Made it easy to promise you’d do something and then never do it.

After her, perhaps two seconds, worth of rapid thoughts- Catra collapsed onto her hands and knees.

She scrambled for the trash bag, claws cutting into it at the top without getting it really opened. Glimmer dropped to her knees hard enough to hurt to wrench it open for her and held it steady as Catra's whole body heaved forward repeatedly, but luckily nothing came up this time.

"Oh my god," Catra groaned, the words barely understandable around the misery, "This sucks!"

"Yeah, containers just don't always-" She paused in horrified fascination as Catra's tongue stuck out to its full length as she gagged. "-uhhh-" Easily went past her chin, just weirdly long. Kinda cool, kinda gross. "-yeah."

"Ee-yeaht!" Catra agreed while also gagging. Okay, now just gross.

"Wildcat!" A large scorpioni woman shouted in alarm, rushing up so fast that her tail knocked some poor elf over at the desk. "Oh my gosh, are you okay!?"

Catra flashed a thumbs up.

Glimmer rolled her eyes. "She will be in about five minutes according to her. Magic allergy."

“I’m NOT all-HERMP!” Catra ducked her head back down into the bag as she finally threw up. “Gods damn it.”

“Oh wow, Entrapta would love to study this.” The absolute unit of woman said, nodding and smiling as if her friend wasn’t vomiting in public right now. “Aw, thanks for bringing her here! Really! It means a lot!! What do I owe you?”

Glimmer winced as Catra moaned pitifully. “You know what? This one is on the house. Hope the engagement goes well!”

“Ha! Yeah! Me too!”

With that Glimmer turned and walked to the counter to see if there were any jobs she could take just to escape this and she had never been more grateful to transport a whole ass vehicle in her life. The complications of all the little parts that rattled around on the inside was a very, very welcome distraction from weird cat women and their magical allergies from hell. Also it got her away from the sick, major bonus.

Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

> Catra doesn't know how to flirt and is going to try anyways, also the plot summary!

“Hey Glimmer.”

She smiled awkwardly as she turned around. “Hey Catra, didn’t think I’d be seeing you again!”

“Yeah. Well.” Catra’s tail lashed behind her, her ears were lowered, and she wouldn’t make eye contact. “Okay, so, hear me out-”

Glimmer’s talents, study, and job made her the kind of person who could take in information (as Adora once put it) scarily fast. She could extrapolate before speakers were even aware of what they’d said. And this, oh boy, this sounded like someone pushing themself for reasons she didn’t care to know. The answer remained the same anyways.

Her smile dropped as she snapped, “Absolutely not, twice is enough to know your limits I think!”

Catra’s eye twitched, her ears turning back and tail flicked rapidly as she huffed. “It’s like exposure therapy! Last time was better than the first one by a long shot, I just need some practice that’s all. Besides, you don’t have a choice.”

“Excuse-” Glimmer’s rage was cut out at the knees as she was handed a Mystacor purchase card, instead causing her to squeak, “me!?”

She couldn’t exactly tell her own boss to go fuck herself, especially because her mother would ground her despite no longer living in her home and that would really mess her up.

Catra looked like she’d won the lottery even as she sweated with nerves hard enough to mat her fur down at her temples. “Yeah, you. So chop chop, we’ve got places to be.”

[Catra starts going regularly for transport but refuses to let anyone else teleport her. Glimmer becomes basically her chauffeur for a while for business. Then Catra starts paying without the business card and asking Glimmer to take her places she’s never been or always wanted to go. They end up doing basically a bunch of one day tourist dates around the world as Catra learns to deal with it. Eventually Catra admits that part of the problem is she had a crush on Glimmer from the start and her stomach would already be in knots before they jumped, but now it’s easier. Glimmer is a little sad thinking that means Catra doesn’t have the crush anymore but actually it’s just that Catra has done the very her thing of realizing if she closes her eyes and feels it out instead, feels the way their molecules blend together for just a moment, that she can do it no problem. She likes getting to keep some of Glimmer and leave some of herself. The two start officially dating.]

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